



IAT Data Management and Protection Guidelines

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Leibniz-Zentrum für
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U N I K A S S E L
V E R S I T Ä T

JUSTUS-LIEBIG-
UNIVERSITÄT
GIESSEN

Hochschule
Geisenheim
University

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

These guidelines set out how members of the Innovation Centre for Agricultural System Transformation manage the data they collect, generate and reuse, and how they protect data that is sensitive or personal. They apply to every IAT project, at ZALF and at the IAT partner universities, and to data at every stage of its life – from the first field campaign to the archived record that outlives the project.

They are written for researchers rather than for lawyers. Each topic below states what is expected, why, and where to get the template or the help that makes it straightforward.

WHAT THESE GUIDELINES COVER

- **Preparing and updating a Data Management Plan.** Every project starts with one and revises it at each reporting milestone, using the IAT template.
- **Working with sensitive data.** How to recognise personal, commercially confidential and location-sensitive data, and what changes once you hold it.
- **Publishing your data.** Depositing the data behind a publication in a trustworthy repository, with a persistent identifier.
- **Sharing and storing data securely.** Which storage is approved for which class of data, and how data moves between partners.
- **Documenting and describing your data.** The minimum metadata that makes a dataset findable and reusable by someone who was not on the project.
- **Choosing a repository and a licence.** Picking the most open licence the consent and the contracts allow, and the repository that fits the discipline.
- **Keeping personal data lawful.** Consent, purpose limitation, retention periods, and when to involve the ZALF data protection officer.
- **Where to get help.** The Data Management Lab, the data protection officer, and the partner university contacts.

WHO IS RESPONSIBLE

Role	Responsibility
Project lead	Accountable for all data the project produces
Data steward	Maintains the DMP and the dataset documentation
Data Management Lab	Provides infrastructure, templates and advice
Data protection officer	Consulted for all processing of personal data